

Promotion Pending

Oozma Kappa

Producer: Maddy Mitchell

Designer: Johnny Santos

Artist: Aiden Hermanowicz

Programmer: Tristan Ford



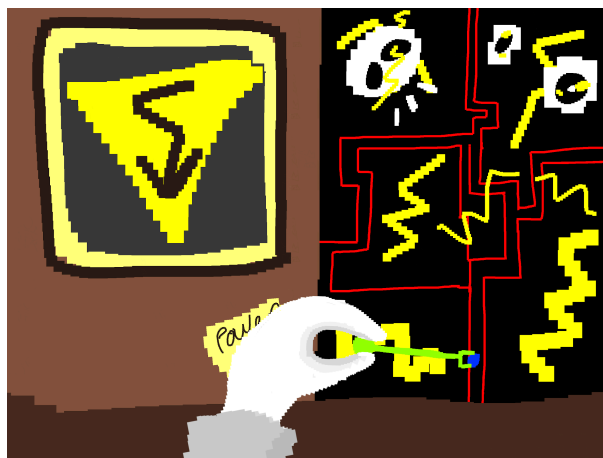
Concept Art Done by: Aiden Hermanowicz

Game Overview

Genre	Platform	Number of Players
Puzzle	PC	1

Key Points

- A fast-paced, top-down puzzle game where the player has only two minutes to survive a hectic day at the factory and earn a promotion.
- Play as Don, a factory foreman determined to earn a \$1,000 promotion bonus before a limited-time sale on his dream bike ends.
- Complete a series of factory puzzles and tasks before the workday timer reaches zero.
- Failing a task or running out of time sends Don back to the beginning of the same workday—but the player keeps the knowledge they gained.
- Learn from each failed attempt, memorize puzzle solutions, and discover the fastest route through the factory.
- Some tasks may be distractions, forcing players to determine which jobs actually matter to earning the promotion.
- Each time loop becomes faster and more efficient as the player learns the factory and masters its challenges.
- Turn mistakes into progress as trial-and-error transforms a seemingly impossible workday into a race the player knows how to beat.
- Finish every required task before time runs out to impress the unseen Boss, earn the promotion, and get Don his \$1,000 bonus.



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Developer Biographies

Maddy Mitchell - Producer

Maddy Mitchell is a Computer Science student at UNC Charlotte with experience in software development, project management, and team leadership. Through multiple software engineering internships at Siemens and leadership roles on campus, she has experience collaborating with teams, managing projects, solving technical problems, and turning ideas into finished products. As the team's Producer, Maddy brings strong organization, communication, and technical knowledge to help keep the development of Promotion Pending on track while supporting the team in creating an engaging and innovative game.

Johnny Santos - Designer

Johnny Santos is a computer science student at UNC Charlotte. He likes stories. He likes reading and playing through stories, since he doesn't write much. His best skill is his imagination, which gives him great ideas. That's what he brings to the team as the Designer.

Aiden Hermanowicz - Artist

Aiden Hermanowicz is a Digital media art student at UNC Charlotte who has been making art and doodles for most of his life. His love of animation and experience in art have given him the skills needed to be able to work as the artist in this project. Aiden also has experience collaborating with other artists and programmers and knows how to respond promptly. As the team artist, not only will Aiden have the skills needed, but he will be able to communicate effectively with the other team members when needed.

Tristan Ford - Programming

Tristan Ford, a computer science student at UNC Charlotte, has been working with technology since he connected the AV and sound cables for his gaming consoles at 3 years old. His love for gaming has always been accompanied by his question of "How was this made?" Fast forward a decade, Tristan has been pouring everything he has into learning the programming side of gaming and looks forward to one day becoming a successful video game developer.

Game Description

Promotion Pending is a pixel, top-down, puzzle game that requires **Don, the factory worker**, to complete his work perfectly for a promotion! This promotion comes with a hefty pay raise that allows him to purchase a brand new motorcycle! The promotion does not come easily, however. While managing puzzles to complete his work, there is the issue of the inevitable steam whistle, indicating that the workday is over. Complete these puzzles perfectly within the time, and Don can find his promotion! Run out of time and the day, and his shot at a promotion is over.

Inside the factory, you will be faced with three puzzles that are required for the promotion. If the time runs out, the day will end, and Don will be forced to face his manager. Without his tasks being complete, Don could be fired. This is his nightmare... literally. If the player fails to complete the tasks in time, Don will wake up from this nightmare and have a strange feeling that his nightmare felt a little too real. This allows the player to retry the day with their previous knowledge. This is how we can introduce the time loop concept into this project.

These puzzles will present themselves as a UI that appears when the player interacts with a desk. These puzzles include a pipe maze, lights out, and electric walls! Whilst there is no enforced penalty for messing up a puzzle, the natural punishment will be wasting your very limited time (1 minute). This makes the day harder to complete the other tasks, while giving the player knowledge for their next run on the following day.

The pipe maze will be a six by six grid filled with three different kinds of pipe: Ninety degree pipes, T-shaped pipes, and straight pipes. The maze will begin from the top of the top left square and end at the bottom of the bottom right square. There is only one viable way to orient the exit pipe but there are three possible paths to get to it, making the player waste time on finding a way out.

Lights out will be a three by three grid with all lights turned on. The player's job will be to turn all the lights off, as fast as they can. The fastest way to solve this problem is in five steps, so it should only be challenging the first couple of times.

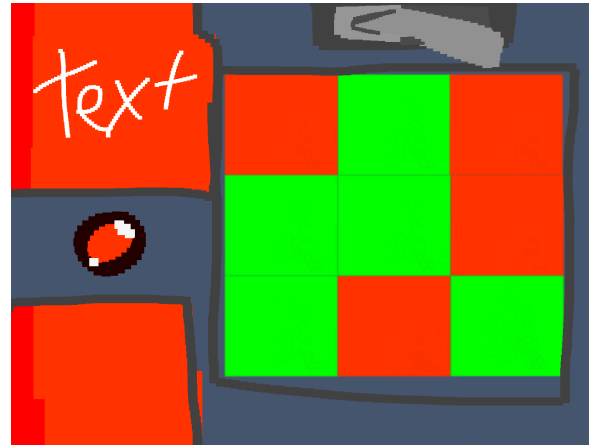
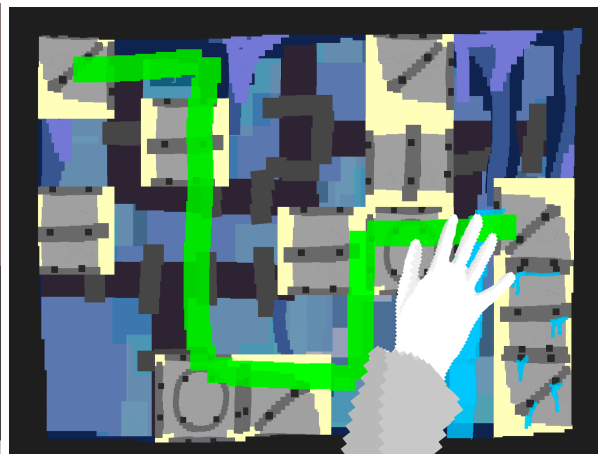
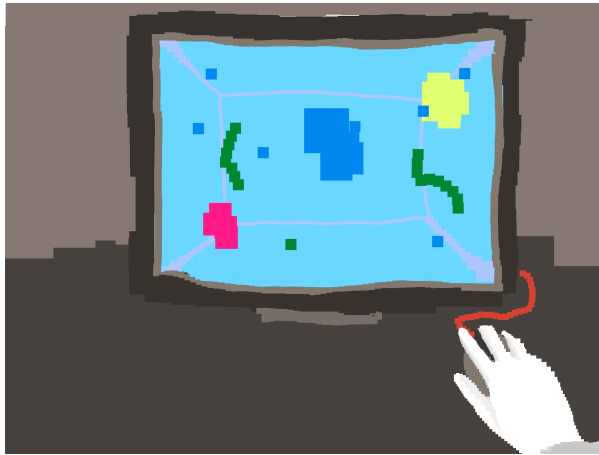
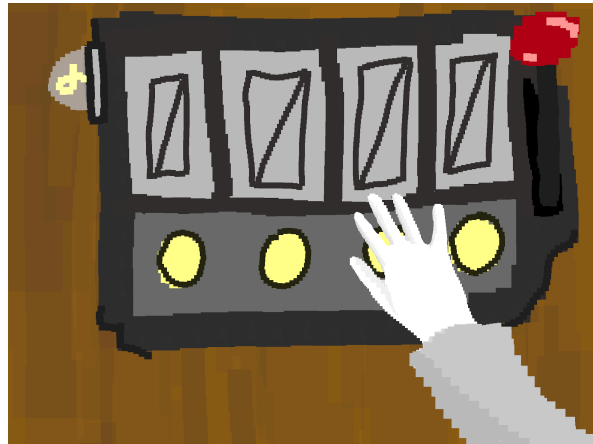
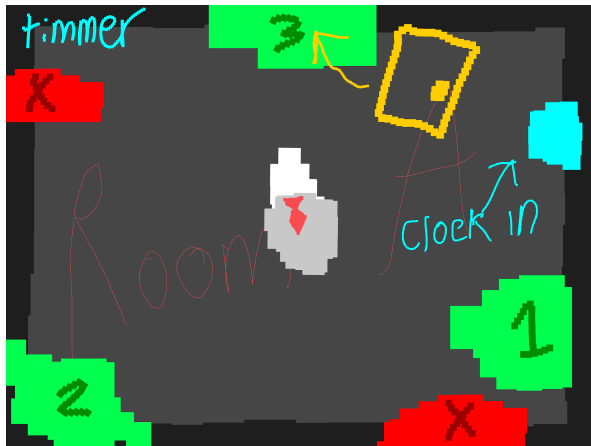
Electric walls will be very similar to operation or the world's hardest game. The player needs to traverse a narrow path without touching the walls, otherwise the puzzle

resets. This tests the player's patience under pressure, making them prone to make mistakes as the time keeps ticking down.

The story will be told through comic style panels and dialogue boxes. This makes the programming lighter since they will use minimal animations. It also allows the player to read at their own pace. The information given to the player will be kept minimal as well, giving an air of mystery to the story.

The ultimate goal of Promotion Pending is to help Don complete his workday and earn the promotion he has been working toward. The player will interact with the factory by exploring the environment, finding tasks, and choosing which puzzles are worth spending their limited time on. While the puzzles themselves provide a challenge, the player's biggest obstacle is learning how to complete the day as efficiently as possible. Each failed attempt gives the player more knowledge about puzzle solutions, task locations, and potential time-wasters that can be used during the next loop. By learning from previous attempts, the player can finally complete every required task before the steam whistle blows, allowing Don to earn his promotion, receive his raise, and purchase the motorcycle he has been dreaming about.

Sample Artwork



All Concept Art Done by: Aiden Hermanowicz